

DD Daniel Davies

Using Feedback Well: Feedback Literacy for Level 4 Business Students

A short course to help you read feedback, use a marking rubric, and improve your next assignment

- Welcome and how to use this course
- Lesson 1: What feedback is and why it matters
- Lesson 2: Reading a marking rubric and grade bands
- Lesson 3: Turning feedback into action
- Lesson 4: Practising evaluative judgement
- Lesson 5: Using generative AI responsibly
- Lesson 6: Check your learning and make a plan
- Your action plan

Powered by Articulate

Welcome and how to use this course

DD Daniel Davies

Powered by Articulate

Welcome

Welcome to this short course on using feedback well.

This course is for Level 4 business students. It is written in plain English. Many students on this course use English as an additional language. That is expected, and it is welcome.

The course takes about 30 to 45 minutes. You can pause and come back.

By the end, you will be able to:

- explain what feedback is, and why it only helps when you use it
- read a marking rubric and understand common UK grade bands
- turn a feedback comment into a clear action for your next assignment
- judge a short piece of work against criteria
- use generative AI in a careful and honest way, if your module allows it

This course was designed by Daniel P Davies, Associate Lecturer at Liverpool John Moores University. He teaches business, and his doctoral research looks at how Level 4

international business students can use feedback well, including feedback from generative AI.

Feedback is useful only when you use it.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

How to use this course

Four steps to get the most from this course.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 1

Work through the lessons in order

There are six short lessons after this welcome. Each one builds on the last.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 2

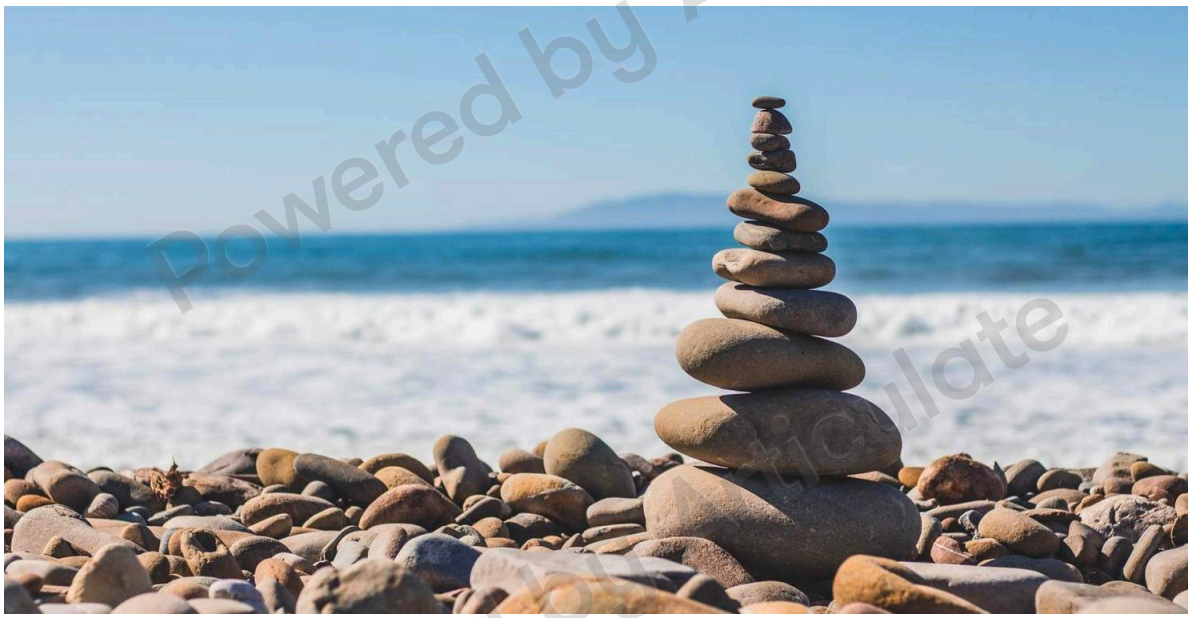
Try every activity

You will see questions, a short scenario, and a sorting task. These are for practice. You can retry them.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 3

Keep a note of one real comment



If you already have feedback from a tutor, keep it beside you. You will use it in the final action plan. If you do not have any yet, you can use the generic example in the course.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 4

Check your own module rules



This course uses generic examples. Your real rubric, grade bands, and rules about generative AI are in your module handbook. If you are unsure, ask your tutor.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Summary

You have reached the end of the steps.

A note about the examples

All sample comments, rubrics, and student paragraphs in this course are generic examples only. They were written for teaching. They are not real student work. They do not come from a real module, and they do not use real marks.

Your own assignments may look different. The skills you practise here will still transfer: reading criteria, judging quality, and deciding what to do next.

CONTINUE

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Lesson 1: What feedback is and why it matters

DD Daniel Davies

Powered by Articulate

What is feedback?

In university, feedback is information about the quality of your work. It can come from a tutor, a marker, a peer, a rubric, or even from you, when you compare your draft with the criteria.

Feedback is not only a mark. A mark tells you where you are. Comments, criteria, and examples help you see why, and what to do next.

Sadler (1989) described feedback as information about the gap between the work you have now and the standard you are aiming for. That information is formative only if you use it to close the gap. In plain terms: feedback helps when it changes what you do next.

Powered by Articulate

Powered by Articulate

A mark or grade

A mark tells you which band your work reached. It is useful, but it is not enough on its own. You also need to know why you were placed there.

Written comments

These may appear on your script, in a marking grid, or in a feedback box. Look for comments that point to a criterion, not only to spelling.

In-class feedback

Tutors often give feedback to the whole group. A live workshop, a worked example, or a short discussion of a sample answer is feedback too.

The marking rubric

The rubric is a description of quality. If you learn to read it, you can judge your draft before you submit.

Peers and your own review

A classmate can tell you what is unclear. You can also review your own work against the criteria. Both of these help you practise judgement.

A mark tells you where you are. Feedback helps you decide where to go next.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Four features of feedback literacy

Carless and Boud (2018) describe feedback literacy as the understandings, capacities, and dispositions you need in order to make sense of feedback and use it. In plain terms, this is what you know about feedback, what you can do with it, and the attitudes that help you use it. They set out four features. Tap each card.

1. Appreciating feedback

This means seeing feedback as useful information for learning, not only as a judgement of you. Comments, criteria, and examples are there to help you improve, not only to explain a mark.

2. Making judgements

This means you can judge the quality of work — your own and other people's — by using criteria. You do not wait until a tutor tells you whether a paragraph is strong.

Powered by Articulate

3. Managing affect	Affect means your feelings. A disappointing mark can feel personal. Feedback literacy includes noticing that feeling, then coming back to the comments so you can still learn from them. The comments are about the work, not about your worth.
4. Taking action	This is the step that closes the gap. You choose one or two changes and apply them in the next draft or the next assignment. Feedback that is read but not used is incomplete.

Powered by Articulate

Why this matters at Level 4

At Level 4 you are learning the subject, and you are also learning how UK university assessment works. The words in a rubric — for example "analysis", "evidence", or "evaluation" — may be new, or they may be used in a new way.

You are not expected to decode this alone. This course gives you a method: read the criteria, judge a piece of work, and turn comments into action.

Winstone and colleagues (2017) showed that a great deal of research has focused on how teachers give feedback, and less on what learners do with it. Your role is active. You receive the comments, but you also decide what they mean and what you will change.

Powered by Articulate

According to this lesson, when is feedback most useful?

- ◯ When it gives you a high mark.
- ◯ When you use the information to close the gap between your work and the standard.
- ◯ When the tutor writes as many comments as possible.
- ◯ When you read the comments once and then file them away.

SUBMIT

Powered by Articulate

Powered by Articulate

Continue to the rubric

Lesson 2: Reading a marking rubric and grade bands

DD Daniel Davies

Powered by Articulate

What is a marking rubric?

A marking rubric (sometimes called assessment criteria, a marking grid, or a grading scheme) is a table or list that describes quality at different grade bands.

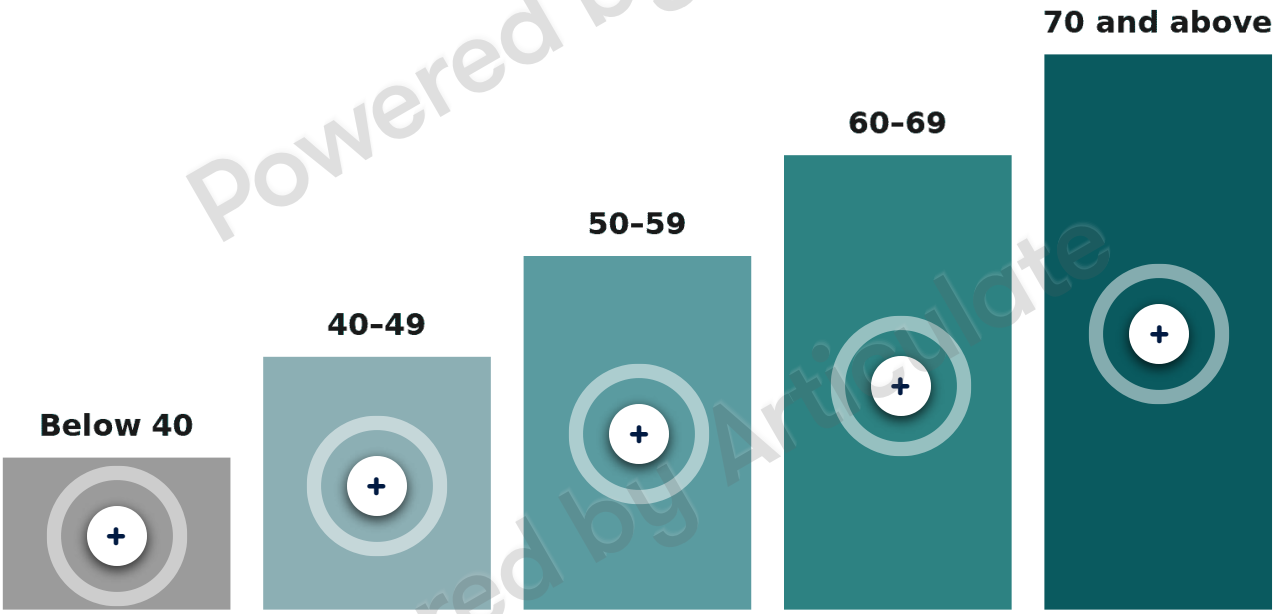
It usually tells you:

- what the tutor is looking for (the criteria)
- how much each criterion is worth (the weighting)
- what work looks like at each band (the descriptors)

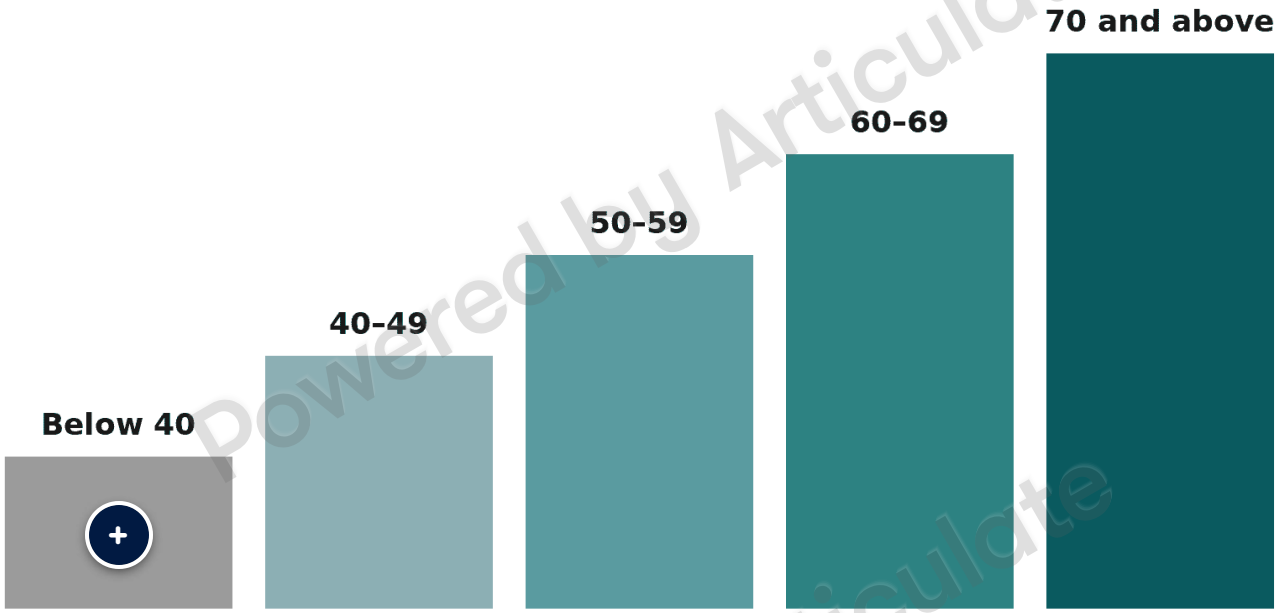
The rubric is there to make the standard visible. You should read it before you start writing, while you draft, and again when you read your feedback.

Reading the rubric once is not enough. O'Donovan, Price, and Rust (2004) found that simply publishing criteria does not give students a working grasp of quality. You build that grasp by using the criteria: comparing examples, judging short pieces of work, and talking about what the words mean.

A rubric is a language of quality. You learn it by using it, not only by reading it once.



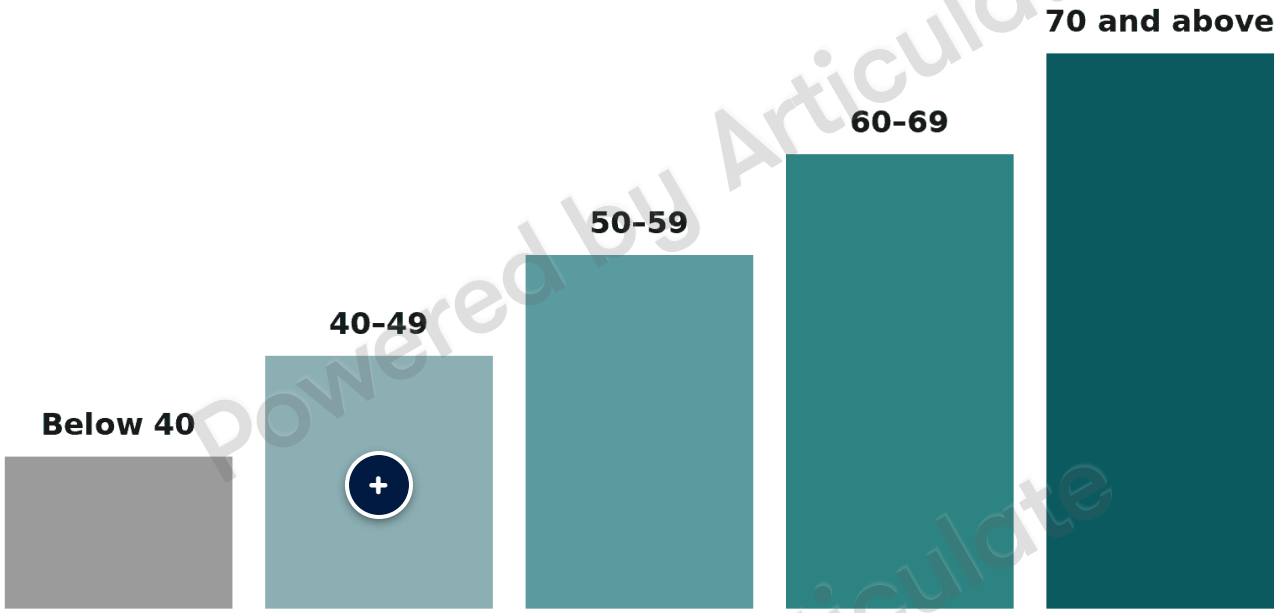
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate



Below 40

In many UK undergraduate modules this is a fail. The work may miss the task, or it may be too incomplete, unclear, or unsupported to meet the pass standard. Some modules offer a referral or resit. Check your handbook.

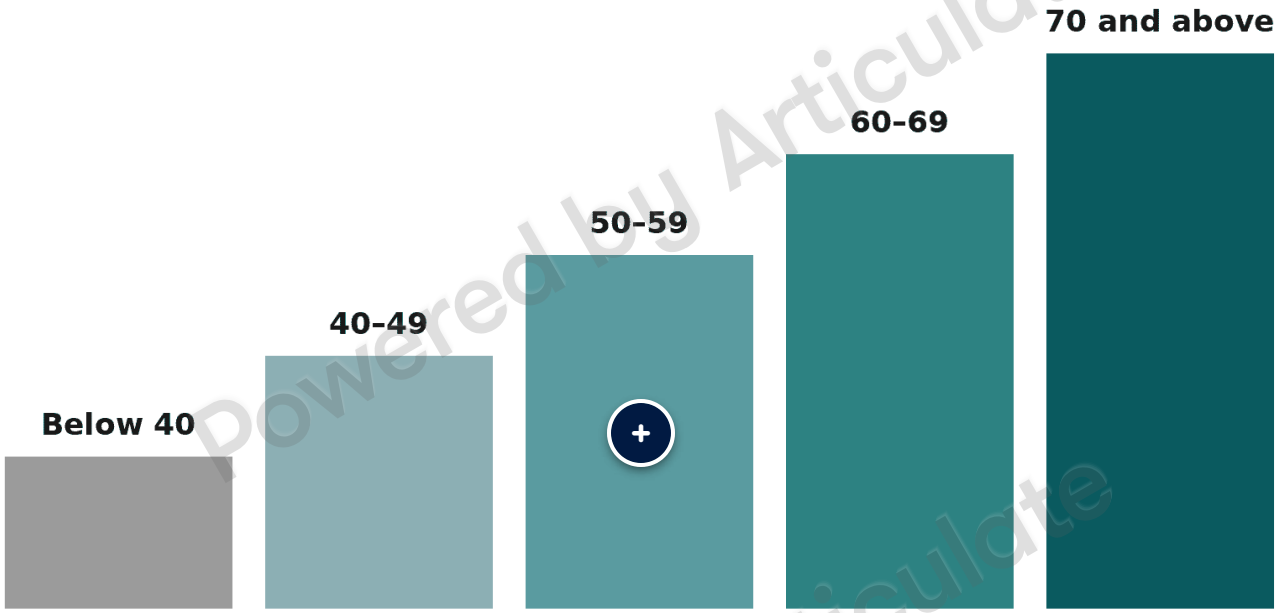
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate



40–49 (often called Third class)

The work meets the task at a basic level. There is some relevant content, but evidence, analysis, or structure is limited. This is a pass in many undergraduate modules, but there is a clear gap to close.

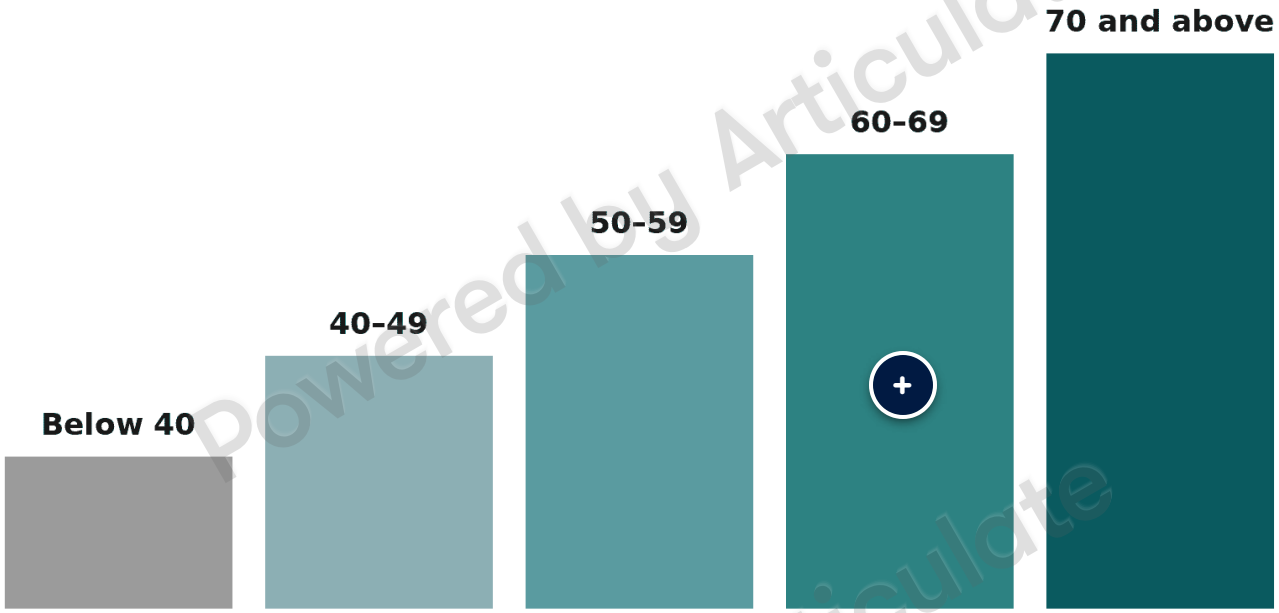
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate



50–59 (often called Lower second, or 2:2)

The work is sound. It addresses the task and uses some evidence. Analysis is present but may be uneven, or some claims may still be too general.

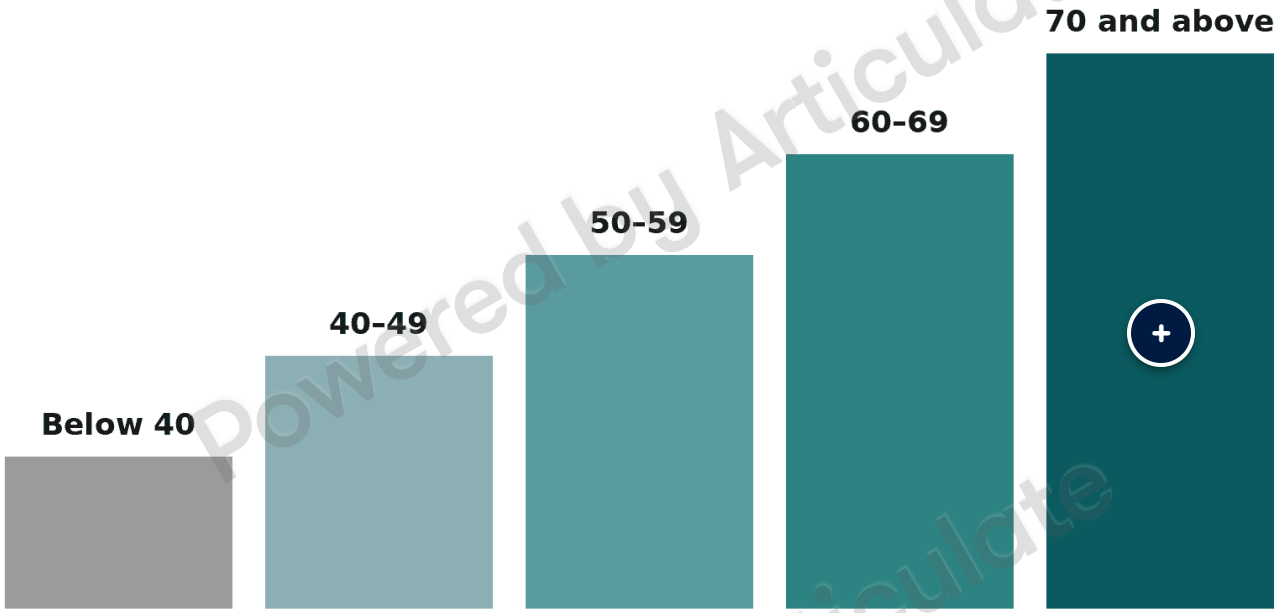
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate



60–69 (often called Upper second, or 2:1)

The work is secure and well organised. Evidence is used to support a clear argument or recommendation. Analysis is consistent, and the writing is controlled.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate



70 and above (often called First class)

The work is excellent for the level. The argument is convincing, the evidence is well chosen, and the analysis is sharp. This does not mean "perfect". It means the work meets the criteria at a very high standard.

Powered by Articulate

Common UK undergraduate grade bands

These are common UK undergraduate conventions. Many Level 4 modules use a pass mark of 40. Your own module may use slightly different labels or descriptors. Always check your handbook.

BELOW 40	40–49	50–59	60–69	70

The task is not met, or is met only in a very incomplete way. Key parts may be missing. Claims may be unsupported or hard to follow. The first job, if you are in this band, is to go back to the brief and the criteria and check what was required.

Powered by Articulate

BELOW 40	40–49	50–59	60–69	70

The task is attempted and there is some relevant material. The recommendation or argument may be present but thin. Evidence is limited. Some writing may be too general ("this is a good idea") without saying why.

Powered by Articulate

BELOW 40	40–49	50–59	60–69	70

The work is clearly on task. There is a structure and some evidence. Analysis appears in places, but some sections may still describe rather than explain. A typical next step is to push every main claim: "According to what evidence, and so what?"

Powered by Articulate

BELOW 40	40–49	50–59	60–69	70

The work is coherent. Evidence is selected and used, not only mentioned. The recommendation or argument is justified. Writing is clear and appropriately academic. A typical next step is to tighten the weakest criterion still further.

BELOW 40	40–49	50–59	60–69	70
The work shows secure judgement. Evidence is well chosen and weighed. The analysis is specific to the case, and the writing is precise. At this level, students often also notice limits or risks, not only benefits.				

Powered by Articulate

A generic example rubric

Use this rubric in the rest of the course. It is a generic example only. It is not a real module rubric, and it does not use a real module code.

Generic example task: Write one short paragraph (about 120 to 150 words). Recommend whether a fictional UK coffee chain, Riverbird Coffee, should open a new branch in a fictional city, Northhaven. Support your recommendation with evidence.

(The company, the city, and any figures used later are invented for teaching.)

Criterion 1 — Use of evidence (30%)

Do you support claims with relevant evidence, and do you say where that evidence comes from?

Criterion 2 — Analysis and justified recommendation (40%)

Do you explain why the evidence leads to your recommendation, rather than only describing the situation?

Criterion 3 — Structure and academic style (30%)

Is the paragraph organised, clear, and written in an appropriately academic style for Level 4?

When you receive feedback, try this habit: highlight each comment, then write the criterion it belongs to in the margin. Comments about "too general" or "where is your source?" usually sit under evidence or analysis, not only under writing style.

Powered by Articulate

Match each grade band to the generic meaning used in this course. These are common UK undergraduate conventions, not the rules of one module.

50–59	Often called First class: excellent for the level, with convincing analysis and well-chosen evidence
Below 40	Often called Upper second (2:1): secure, well organised, and consistently justified
70 and above	Often called Lower second (2:2): sound and on task, but analysis may be uneven
40–49	Often called Third class: a basic pass in many modules, with limited evidence or analysis

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

60–69	In many undergraduate modules this is a fail: the task is not met at the pass standard

SUBMIT

A tutor writes: "Your recommendation is clear, but you do not show where your claims come from." In the generic example rubric, which criterion does this comment mainly belong to?

- Use of evidence.
- Analysis and justified recommendation.
- Structure and academic style.
- The mark, and nothing else.

SUBMIT

Powered by Articulate

Continue to taking action

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Lesson 3: Turning feedback into action

DD Daniel Davies

Powered by Articulate

From comments to the next assignment

Reading feedback is only the first step. The useful step is feed-forward: using what you have learned in the next piece of work.

Hattie and Timperley (2007) describe effective feedback as answering three questions:

- Where am I going? (What is the standard or goal?)
- How am I going? (Where is my work now?)
- Where to next? (What should I change?)

That third question is feed-forward. Carless and Boud (2018) also place taking action among the four features of feedback literacy. A comment that is understood but not applied does not yet close the gap.

You do not need to fix everything at once. Choose one or two actions that will make the biggest difference in the next assignment.

A five-step action plan

Use these five steps each time you receive feedback.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 1

Read the whole set of comments once

Do this before you judge them. If a comment is hard to understand, look up key words in the rubric, or ask a trusted peer. You can also ask your tutor. If you use a translation tool, check the meaning afterwards.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 2

Name the feeling, then set it to one side

A lower mark than you hoped for can sting. That reaction is common. The comments are about the work, not about your worth. When you are ready, come back to the text of the feedback.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 3

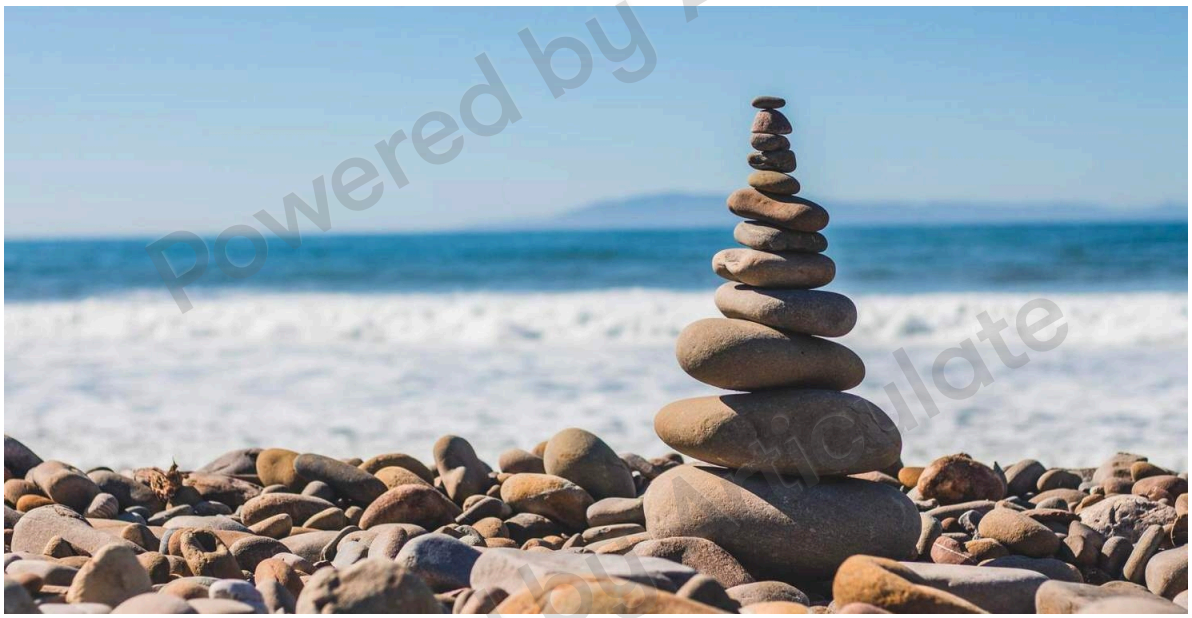
Match each comment to a criterion

Write the criterion name beside the comment. This stops you from spending all your energy on surface changes, such as wording, when the main gap is evidence or analysis.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 4

Write one or two specific actions



Turn each priority comment into a sentence you can do. Weak: "I will try harder." Stronger: "In my next paragraph, I will support every main claim with a source, and I will say how that source supports my recommendation."

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 5

Decide when and how you will check



Put the action on a real draft, and give yourself a check point: "I will test this on my next plan, before I write the full assignment." If you are unsure, take one question to your tutor or a skills tutor.

Powered by Articulate

Summary

You now have a simple routine you can repeat after every piece of feedback.

Powered by Articulate

Generic example: comments turned into actions

These comments are **generic examples only**. They are not from a real student script.

“Your recommendation is clear, but your claims are too general.”

Action: In the next assignment I will replace at least two general claims (for example, "customers will like this") with a specific piece of evidence, and I will explain what that evidence means for my recommendation.

Powered by Articulate

Powered by Articulate



“You describe the situation, but you do not analyse it.”

Action: After each piece of evidence I will add a "so what?" sentence: why this evidence supports, weakens, or limits my recommendation.

“Please check your paragraph structure.”

Action: I will write a short plan before I draft: one sentence for the recommendation, two sentences for evidence, one sentence for a risk or limit, and one sentence to close.

“Well done: your introduction sets up the task clearly.”

Action: This is not only praise to enjoy. It is a practice to keep. I will use the same clear set-up in the next assignment, and spend my revision time on the weaker criterion instead.

Powered by Articulate

1. THE FEEDBACK ARRIVES | 2A. ONLY THE MARK | 2B. ASKING A TOOL TO WRITE IT | 2C. ASKING ABOUT THE MARK | 3. A

Maya is a Level 4 business student. She has just received feedback on a short written task.
The mark is 52%. The comments say:
"Your recommendation is clear, but you do not use enough evidence. Several claims are too general. Please apply this in your next assignment."
Maya had hoped for a mark in the 60s. She feels disappointed and a little embarrassed.
What should she do first?
Choice A: Close the feedback and look only at the mark.
Feedback: This leaves Maya with a number, but no plan. A mark cannot tell her what to change. The comments already point to a criterion: use of evidence.
Goes to: Tab 2A. Only the mark
Choice B: Ask a generative AI tool to write the next assignment for her, so the mark goes up.
Feedback: This skips the learning. It also risks academic misconduct, depending on the module rules. Maya would not practise the skill the feedback is asking for: using evidence herself.
Goes to: Tab 2B. Asking a tool to write it
Choice C: Notice the disappointment, then match the comments to the rubric and write two actions for the next assignment.
Feedback: Yes. Maya is managing affect, making a judgement, and taking action. That is feedback literacy in practice (Carless & Boud, 2018).
Goes to: Tab 3. A usable plan
Choice D: Email the tutor only to complain that the mark is too low.
Feedback: It is fair to ask for clarification if a comment is unclear. A complaint about the mark alone, with no question about the work, is less likely to help. Maya can come back to the tutor with a specific question after she has read the rubric.
Goes to: Tab 2C. Asking about the mark

1. THE FEEDBACK ARRIVES | 2A. ONLY THE MARK | 2B. ASKING A TOOL TO WRITE IT | 2C. ASKING ABOUT THE MARK | 3. A

Maya knows she got 52%, but she cannot say what to do differently next time. A few weeks later, her next paragraph has the same problem: a clear recommendation with little evidence.
What can she do now?
Choice A: Go back to the earlier comments, match them to the rubric, and write two actions before starting the next draft.
Feedback: Yes. It is not too late. Feedback can still be used on a later task. This is feed-forward.

Powered by Articulate

Goes to: Tab 3. A usable plan
Choice B: Decide that feedback arrives too late to be useful, and ignore it.
Feedback: Some comments do arrive after a module has moved on. Even then, the same criteria often reappear in later assignments. Ignoring the comments wastes that chance.
Goes to: Try a different approach. Go back and try the option where Maya writes a short action plan. That is the habit this course is building.

Powered by Articulate

A generative AI tool can produce a fluent paragraph quickly. It may also invent evidence, miss the brief, or write in a voice that is not Maya's. If she submits that paragraph as her own work, she may break her module's academic integrity rules.
There is a more careful way to use a tool, if her module allows it.
Choice A: Use the tool only to help explain the comment "too general", then write the next paragraph herself and check every claim.
Feedback: This is more responsible, but Maya must still check her own module rules, and she must keep her own voice. The next lesson looks at this in more detail.
Goes to: Tab 3. A usable plan
Choice B: Submit the tool's paragraph anyway, because it sounds academic.
Feedback: Fluent writing is not the same as honest work, and it is not the same as good evidence. This is not an acceptable route. Go back and choose a plan that Maya can carry out herself.
Goes to: Try a different approach. Submitting generated text as your own work is not acceptable. Try the path where Maya writes her own action plan.

Powered by Articulate

Tutors can explain comments, and you should ask if you do not understand them. A message that only says "I think my mark is too low" is harder to answer than a precise question.
Maya could write: "I can see that evidence is the main gap. Please could you show me one sentence in my paragraph where a source would have helped?"
Choice A: Rewrite the email as a specific question, then write two actions from the comments she already has.

Powered by Articulate

Feedback: Yes. She is using the tutor as a partner, and she is still taking action herself.
Goes to: Tab 3. A usable plan
Choice B: Do nothing until the tutor changes the mark.
Feedback: Marks are based on the criteria. Waiting for a change, without working on the evidence gap, will not prepare Maya for the next task.
Goes to: Try a different approach. You can ask a tutor for clarification, but you still need a plan. Try the option where Maya writes two actions.

Powered by Articulate

1. THE FEEDBACK ARRIVES	2A. ONLY THE MARK	2B. ASKING A TOOL TO WRITE IT	2C. ASKING ABOUT THE MARK	3. A

Maya writes two actions:
1. "In my next paragraph, I will support every main claim with a piece of evidence and say where it comes from."
2. "After each piece of evidence, I will add one sentence that explains why it supports my recommendation."
She also writes one question for her tutor: "Is a short case fact acceptable evidence for this type of task, or do I need a published source?"
This is feed-forward. The mark of 52% has become a plan, not only a disappointment.
End of scenario. You will write a plan like this for yourself at the end of the course.

Powered by Articulate

Powered by Articulate

A student receives this comment: "You describe the company, but you do not explain why your evidence supports the recommendation." What is the strongest next action?

- ○ Change a few words so the paragraph sounds more academic.
- ○ Add a "so what?" sentence after each piece of evidence,

explaining how it supports the recommendation.

Ignore the comment, because the recommendation was already clear.

Write a much longer description of the company.

SUBMIT

Continue to judging quality

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Lesson 5 of 8

Lesson 4: Practising evaluative judgement

DD Daniel Davies

Powered by Articulate

What is evaluative judgement?

Evaluative judgement is the ability to make decisions about the quality of work — your own work, and other people's work (Tai, Ajjawi, Boud, Dawson, & Panadero, 2018).

It is a core aim of higher education, not a side effect of getting a mark. If you can judge quality, you can improve a draft before you submit it. You can also make better use of tutor comments, because you can see where they fit.

You build this ability by using criteria, not by waiting for a tutor to tell you whether a paragraph is strong.

Sadler (1989) argued that students need three things: a concept of quality, a way to compare their own work with that concept, and a set of tactics for improvement. This lesson practises the first two, using a short generic example.

A weak use of evidence	Claims are general and unsourced. For example: "Customers will like this" or "This is a good idea." A stronger paragraph supports each main claim with a specific piece of evidence and says where it comes from.
A weak recommendation	The recommendation is vague, or it is stated without a reason. For example: "The company should expand." A stronger paragraph makes a clear yes/no or conditional recommendation and justifies it.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Description rather than analysis	The paragraph retells facts but does not explain what they mean. A stronger paragraph asks "so what?": why this evidence supports, weakens, or limits the recommendation.
A stronger academic style	The paragraph is organised, uses complete sentences, and avoids slogans. It sounds like a Level 4 business recommendation, not a full essay, and not an advertisement.

Powered by Articulate

Generic example: a sample paragraph to judge

Read the paragraph below. It is a generic example only. It is not real student work. The company, the city, and the situation are invented for teaching.

Then judge it against the three criteria:

1. Use of evidence (30%)

2. Analysis and justified recommendation (40%)

3. Structure and academic style (30%)

The sample paragraph (invented for teaching):

"Riverbird Coffee should open a new branch in Northhaven because this is a good idea. Many companies grow when they open in new places, and the brand is strong. Customers like the products, so the shop will be busy. There are some risks, but these can be managed. In conclusion, a new branch will help the company be successful and increase profits."

Keep this paragraph on screen as you answer the next questions. You are not marking a real person. You are practising judgement.

Powered by Articulate

Which of the following are problems in the sample paragraph? Select all that apply.

- [ ] The recommendation is given, but the claims are too general.
- [ ] There is no usable evidence, and no source is given.

- [ ] The paragraph names risks but does not analyse them.
- [ ] The paragraph never makes a recommendation.
- [ ] The paragraph is far too long for the task.

SUBMIT

Using only the generic example rubric and grade bands in this course, which band is the best fit for the sample paragraph?

- ( ) 70 and above (First class).
- ( ) 60–69 (Upper second, 2:1).
- ( ) 50–59 (Lower second, 2:2).
- ( ) 40–49 (Third class, a basic pass in many undergraduate modules).
- ( ) Below 40 (a fail in many undergraduate modules).

SUBMIT

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

A stronger rewrite of the same task

Now compare the first paragraph with this stronger rewrite. This is also a generic example only. It is not real student work. The figures in it are invented for teaching, so that you can see how evidence and analysis look in a short paragraph. Do not treat them as real data.

Stronger rewrite (invented for teaching):

"Riverbird Coffee should open a small branch near Northhaven station, but only as a limited trial. In this teaching example, a short local survey of 40 office workers found that 28 said they would buy coffee at lunchtime if a branch opened beside the station. That suggests there is midday demand in a high-footfall site. However, the same survey is small and was not independently verified, so it should not be treated as proof of long-term profit. A three-month trial would test demand and costs before the company commits to a full lease."

Notice what has changed:

- The recommendation is still clear, but it is now conditional (a limited trial).
- A specific piece of evidence is used, and its limit is named.
- A "so what?" sentence links the evidence to the decision.
- The paragraph has a simple shape: recommendation, evidence, limit, next step.

This rewrite would sit higher on the generic rubric, most likely in the 60–69 band in this teaching example, because the evidence is used and weighed. It would not automatically

Powered by Articulate

be a First. A still stronger version might use more than one source, or compare two sites.

The point is not to memorise a band. The point is that you can now see the difference, and you can use that judgement on your own drafts.

Continue to using AI carefully

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Lesson 5: Using generative AI responsibly

DD Daniel Davies

Powered by Articulate

Use AI as a support, not as a substitute

Generative AI tools (for example, ChatGPT and similar products) can explain a phrase, suggest questions, or help you check the clarity of a sentence. They can also invent sources, miss your brief, or write in a voice that is not yours.

This course does not give one institution's AI rules. Rules differ by module. Some tasks allow limited use. Some tasks allow no use. Before you use a tool for assessed work, check your module handbook, the assignment brief, and your tutor.

If a tool is allowed, you remain responsible for the work you submit. Bearman, Tai, Dawson, Boud, and Ajjawi (2024) argue that students need to judge the quality of generative AI outputs, and that humans should remain the arbiters of quality. In plain terms: the tool can make a suggestion. You decide whether it is accurate, relevant, and honest.

If you use a generative AI tool, you still have to judge the output. Keep your own voice, and check

your own module rules.

OFTEN HELPFUL (STILL CHECK YOUR RULES)	RISKY — ASK YOUR TUTOR FIRST	NOT ACCEPTABLE

These uses can support learning, but only if your module allows them, and only if you check the result:

- asking the tool to explain a rubric phrase in simpler English, then checking that meaning against the handbook
- asking the tool to help you understand a feedback comment
- asking the tool to suggest questions you could take to your tutor
- pasting your own short sentence and asking whether it is clear, then rewriting it yourself

Even here, the tool can be wrong. It may simplify a criterion too far, or change its meaning.

OFTEN HELPFUL (STILL CHECK YOUR RULES)	RISKY — ASK YOUR TUTOR FIRST	NOT ACCEPTABLE

These uses may be allowed in one module and not in another:

- using a tool to generate a plan or outline for an assessed task
- using a tool to improve the language of a whole draft
- using a tool to suggest sources (it may invent them)
- using a tool during a timed or invigilated assessment

If the brief is silent, do not assume that use is allowed. Ask.

OFTEN HELPFUL (STILL CHECK YOUR RULES)	RISKY — ASK YOUR TUTOR FIRST	NOT ACCEPTABLE

These uses are not consistent with academic integrity, even if the writing looks fluent:

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

• asking the tool to write the assignment, and submitting that text as your own
• inventing or accepting sources you have not read, because the tool provided them
• hiding your use of a tool when your module asks you to declare it
• using a tool to bypass the very skill the task is assessing (for example, your own analysis or recommendation)

Fluent English is not the same as honest work.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

A four-step check before you trust an AI suggestion

Work through the four steps below before you use any AI suggestion.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 1

Check the rules first

Look at the brief and the module handbook. If AI use must be declared, declare it in the way your module asks. If use is not allowed for this task, do not use the tool.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 2

Keep the task and the criteria in view

Paste or restate the criterion or the comment, not the whole assessed task, unless your tutor has said that this is allowed. Ask a precise question. For example: "Explain the phrase 'too general' in feedback on a short business recommendation."

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 3

Check the output against evidence you can see

Does the suggestion invent a fact, a source, or a figure? If you cannot find that evidence yourself, do not use it. Does the suggestion still answer the brief? Does it still sound like you?

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 4

Rewrite in your own voice, then decide

If a suggestion is useful, put it into your own words and apply it yourself. You are the author of the work you submit. You are also the person who will be asked to explain it.

Often helpful, if your module allows it — then check the result

I ask the tool to explain the rubric phrase "justified recommendation" in simple

I ask the tool to suggest questions I could take to my tutor about a feedback co

I use the tool to translate a feedback comment so I can understand it, then I ch

Powered by Articulate

Ask your tutor first

I ask the tool to produce a full outline for my assessed assignment.

I ask the tool to rewrite my whole draft in a more academic style before I submi

Not acceptable

I paste the assignment brief and ask the tool to write the paragraph, then I sub

I ask the tool to invent two academic sources that support my recommendation, an

I use the tool in a test or other assessment where the brief says no AI use is a

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

A student wants to use a generative AI tool after receiving feedback. Which of the following are responsible steps? Select all that apply.

- [ ] Check the module handbook and the assignment brief before using the tool.
- [ ] Check any suggested fact or source against evidence they can actually find and read.
- [ ] Keep their own voice, and be ready to explain the work as their own judgement.
- [ ] Submit the tool's paragraph if it sounds more academic than their own writing.
- [ ] Assume that if classmates use a tool, it must be allowed.

SUBMIT

Powered by Articulate

Continue to the quiz and action plan

Lesson 7 of 8

Lesson 6: Check your learning and make a plan

DD Daniel Davies

This short quiz has eight questions. It checks the ideas you have just practised. You can retry it. You need 6 out of 8 to pass. After the quiz, you will write a personal action plan.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Question

01/08

Feedback is most useful when:

- It is as long as possible.
- You use the information to close the gap between your current work and the standard.
- It is only a mark, with no comments.
- You read it once and then forget it until results day.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Question

02/08

Carless and Boud (2018) set out four features of feedback literacy: appreciating feedback, making judgements, managing affect, and taking action. What does "managing affect" mean in this course?

- ◯ Changing your handwriting so the work looks neater.
- ◯ Asking the tutor to remove any comment that feels critical.
- ◯ Noticing feelings such as disappointment, and still coming back to the comments so you can learn from them.
- ◯ Ignoring feedback so that you do not have to feel disappointed.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Question

03/08

In the common UK undergraduate conventions used in this course, a mark of 62% usually sits in which band?

- ◯ Below 40, often a fail.
- ◯ 40–49, often called Third class.
- ◯ 50–59, often called Lower second (2:2).
- ◯ 60–69, often called Upper second (2:1).
- ◯ 70 and above, often called First class.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Question

04/08

O'Donovan, Price, and Rust (2004) argued that simply publishing criteria is not enough. What should you do as well?

- Memorise the rubric wording the night before submission.
- Practise using the criteria, for example by judging examples and comparing them with your own work.
- Ignore the rubric until after the mark is released.
- Ask a generative AI tool to rewrite the rubric for you, and follow that version only.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Question

05/08

A tutor writes: "You describe the situation, but you do not explain why your evidence supports the recommendation." What is the strongest feed-forward action?

- Add a longer background section about the company.
- Change the recommendation to the opposite view, without new reasons.
- After each piece of evidence, add a "so what?" sentence that explains how it supports the recommendation.
- Delete all of the evidence so the paragraph is shorter.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Question

06/08

Look again at this generic example paragraph, invented for teaching and not taken from real student work:
"Riverbird Coffee should open a new branch in Northhaven because this is a good idea. Many companies grow when they open in new places, and the brand is strong. Customers like the products, so the shop will be busy. There are some risks, but these can be managed. In conclusion, a new branch will help the company be successful and increase profits."
On the generic rubric in this course, why is 40–49 the best-fit band?

- Because the paragraph is written in poor English.
- Because the task is attempted and a recommendation is made, but evidence is missing and analysis is very thin.
- Because any short paragraph is automatically a fail.
- Because the paragraph already uses specific, well-weighed evidence.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Question

07/08

Which of the following are acceptable principles for using generative AI in this course's advice? Select all that apply.

- [ ] Check your own module handbook and assignment brief, because rules differ.
- [ ] If you use a tool, check the output and keep your own voice.
- [ ] Submit generated text as your own if it sounds more academic than your draft.
- [ ] Do not add sources that you have not actually read.
- [ ] If a classmate uses a tool, you can assume it is allowed.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Question

08/08

Evaluative judgement, as used in this course, means:

- Giving yourself a higher mark than the tutor gave you.
- The ability to make decisions about the quality of work, including your own work and other people's work.
- Waiting until the tutor tells you whether a paragraph is good.
- Using a generative AI tool to grade your work so you do not have to read the rubric.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Lesson 8 of 8

Your action plan

DD Daniel Davies

Write your own plan now

You have practised the method. Now apply it to your own work.

Use feedback you already have, if you have any. If you do not, use this generic example comment:

"Your recommendation is clear, but you do not use enough evidence. Several claims are too general. Please apply this in your next assignment."

Copy the template below into your notes, or into a document you will keep. Complete every line in full sentences.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Personal action plan template

Complete each step in full sentences.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 1

The comment I will use

Write one real comment from your tutor, or the generic example comment above.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 2

The criterion it belongs to

Name the criterion (for example: use of evidence; analysis; structure and style). If you are unsure, say why, and note a question for your tutor.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 3

My specific action

Write one or two sentences that start with "In my next assignment I will...". Make the action visible in the work (for example, "I will support every main claim with a source"). Avoid vague promises such as "I will try harder".

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 4

When I will do it

Name a real time, such as "when I write the plan for my next assignment" or "before I submit the next draft".

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 5

How I will check it

For example: "I will highlight each claim in my draft and check that a source or a reason sits beside it." Or: "I will ask a peer to see whether my recommendation is justified."

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate

Step 6

If I am unsure

Write one question you could take to your tutor, a seminar leader, or a skills tutor. Keep it specific.

You do not need to fix everything at once. One or two specific actions, used in the next assignment, will take you further than a long list you never apply.

Before you go

You can now:

- explain what feedback is, and why it only helps when you use it
- read a generic marking rubric and the common UK undergraduate grade bands
- turn a comment into a short action plan
- judge a short paragraph against criteria
- use generative AI more carefully, if your module allows it, without giving away your own voice

Powered by Articulate

Take the action plan into your next assignment. If a comment is still unclear, ask your tutor a precise question. That is not a weakness. It is part of using feedback well.

Thank you for working through this course.

Further reading

These sources informed the course. They are listed for tutors, and for students who want to go further. You do not need to read them in order to complete the activities.

• Bearman, M., Tai, J., Dawson, P., Boud, D., & Ajjawi, R. (2024). Developing evaluative judgement for a time of generative artificial intelligence. Assessment & Evaluation in Higher Education, 49(6), 893–905. https://doi.org/10.1080/02602938.2024.2335321

• Carless, D., & Boud, D. (2018). The development of student feedback literacy: Enabling uptake of feedback. Assessment & Evaluation in Higher Education, 43(8), 1315–1325. https://doi.org/10.1080/02602938.2018.1463354

• Hattie, J., & Timperley, H. (2007). The power of feedback. Review of Educational Research, 77(1), 81–112. https://doi.org/10.3102/003465430298487

• O'Donovan, B., Price, M., & Rust, C. (2004). Know what I mean? Enhancing student understanding of assessment standards and criteria. Teaching in Higher Education, 9(3), 325–335. https://doi.org/10.1080/1356251042000216642

• Sadler, D. R. (1989). Formative assessment and the design of instructional systems. Instructional Science, 18(2), 119–144. https://doi.org/10.1007/BF00117714

• Tai, J., Ajjawi, R., Boud, D., Dawson, P., & Panadero, E. (2018). Developing evaluative judgement: Enabling students to make decisions about the quality of work. Higher Education, 76(3), 467–481. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10734-017-0220-3

Powered by Articulate

• Winstone, N. E., Nash, R. A., Parker, M., & Rowntree, J. (2017). Supporting learners' agentic engagement with feedback: A systematic review and a taxonomy of recipience processes. Educational Psychologist, 52(1), 17–37. https://doi.org/10.1080/00461520.2016.1207538

All seven sources are already verified in the author's literature review.

Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate
Powered by Articulate